

Ji Ye Kim

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EDUCATION

University of Southern California, Los Angeles, California, USA

- Ph.D. in Communication (ABD) Aug 2023 –
 - Adviser: Dr. Dmitri Williams
 - Dissertation (in progress): *Toxic and Prosocial Gameplay in Online Games: Relationship Selection and Socially Driven Behavior*
 - This dissertation examines toxic and prosocial play in online multiplayer games as multidimensional social behaviors, using social network analysis and computational text classification to explain relationship selection and social influence.
 - Committee: Dr. Dmitri Williams (Chair), Dr. Aimei Yang, Dr. Lindsay Young
 - Research Areas: Game studies, media psychology, social network analysis, computational methods, natural language processing

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill, Chapel Hill, North Carolina, USA

- M.A. in Media and Communication: Theory and Research Track Aug 2021 – May 2023
 - Adviser: Dr. Francesca Dillman Carpentier
 - Thesis: Do Users Reveal the Needs that Motivate Them to Watch Gaming Videos? A Computational Analysis of Gaming Video User Comments on YouTube

Ewha Womans University, Seoul, South Korea

- B.S. in Content Convergence (Primary Major)
- B.C.M in Communication and Media (Second Major) Mar 2016 – Feb 2021
 - Graduated summa cum laude
 - Cumulative GPA: 3.93 / 4.00
 - Thesis (Content Convergence): Does the viewer's gender of YouTube "Eating Show" correlate with the viewer's watching motivation, preference, and the creator's gender?
 - Thesis (Communication and Media): Algorithm Design for Augmented Reality Applications to Digital Advertisements

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Annenberg Game Lab (TGG), University of Southern California

- Research Assistant Jan 2026 – Present
 - Project: Games Studies
 - Lead bi-weekly meetings and prepare discussion materials
 - Present data analysis strategies for working with game data
 - Lead survey planning for World of Tanks

Social Value Lab (SV), University of Southern California

- Research Assistant Jan 2026 – Present
 - Project: Theoretical Framework for Social Value and Receptivity in Online Game Environments
 - Model Social Value and Receptivity using random forest regression with game behavioral data
 - Analyze network and behavioral data to examine relational influence dynamics in online game environments
 - Prepare research discussion materials and coordinate bi-weekly meetings

Annenberg Networks Network (ANN), University of Southern California

- Research Assistant Jan 2025 – May 2026
 - Project: Climate Change Misinformation
 - Lead weekly meetings and prepare discussion materials
 - Analyze survey data collected from Prolific
 - Design an experimental study on conformity to climate change information in social networks
 - Conduct literature review to support project development

PUBLICATIONS PEER-REVIEWED JOURNAL ARTICLES

- IF = Impact Factor

- [3] Kim, J. Y., Kim, D., Zhou, S., Wang, Z., Williams, D., & Yang, A. (in press). Different gameplay styles, different psychological needs: Extending relatedness through behavioral indicators. *Journal of Media Psychology*. (SSCI, IF = 1.9).
- [2] Kim, J. Y., & Williams, D. (2026). No player is an island: Belonging, identity and skill in online game teams. *Entertainment Computing*, 58, 101171. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.entcom.2026.101171> (SCIE, IF = 2.4).
- [1] Wang, Z., Zhou, S., Wang, J., Zhu, J., Kim, D., Jung, B., Kim, J. Y., Balasubramanian, A., Zou, V., & Young, L. E. (2026). Protest images and interaction networks within affective publics during the 2024 South Korean martial law crisis. *Computational Communication Research*, 8(3), 1-24. <https://doi.org/10.5117/CCR2026.3.3.WANG> (Scopus Q1).

PEER-REVIEWED MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

- [4] Kim, J. Y., Young, L. E., Kim, D., Curry, M., Wang, Z., Twyman, M., & Yang, A. (2026). Interpersonal communication environments and counterarguing intentions toward climate misinformation: The role of personal climate discussion networks, norms, and attitudes. *Environment and Behavior*
 - Under Review (Minor Revision)
- [3] Kim, D., Kim, J. Y., & Wang, Z. (2026). Measuring social influence through behavioural data: A computational model of Social Value in networks. *Sage Research Methods: Data- and Research Literacy*
 - Under Review (Minor Revision)
- [2] Kim, J. Y. & Yang, A. (2026). Socializing, learning, laughing: Motivational patterns in YouTube comments across gaming video types. *Computers in Human Behavior*
 - Under Review
- [1] Kim, J. Y. & Young, L. E. (2026) Understanding paying it forward in online gaming: A COM-B model approach in Sky: Children of the light. *Cyberpsychology, Behavior, and Social Networking*
 - Under Review

PRESENTATIONS CONFERENCES

- [11] Kim, J. Y., Kim, D. & Jung, B. Understanding Paying it Forward in Online Gaming: A COM-B Model Approach in Sky: Children of the Light Nov 2026
 - NCA 2026, New Orleans, LA
 - Division: Game Studies
 - High density paper session
- [10] Kim, J. Y., Kim, D., Curry, M. & Wang, Z. Personal Discussion Networks Shape Counterarguing Intentions against Climate Misinformation Through Pro-Climate Norms and Attitudes Jun 2026
 - ICA 2026, Cape Town, South Africa
 - Division: Environmental Communication
 - Standard paper session
- [9] Kim, D., Kim, J. Y., Wang, Z., Kim, N., & Jung, B. When Influencers Use AI Agents: How Transparency Shapes Audience Reactions Apr 2026
 - 2026 Annenberg Graduate Fellowship Research and Creative Project Symposium, Los Angeles, CA
 - E-poster session
- [8] Kim, J. Y. & Curry, M. Social Influence and Spending Behavior in MMORPG Networks Jan 2026
 - Korea University - University of Southern California Symposium
 - Session: Cultural Industry Networks, Platform Power, and Market Structures
 - Virtual presentation session
- [7] Kim, J. Y., Kim, D., Zhuo, S., Wang, Z., Williams, D. & Yang, A. Different Gameplay Styles, Different Psychological Needs: Extending Relatedness Through Behavioral Indicators Nov 2025
 - NCA 2025, Denver, CO
 - Division: Games Studies
 - High density paper session
- [6] Kim, D., Wang, Z., Kim, J. Y., & Jung, B. Cognitive and Affective Trust in Intention to Use Fully Autonomous LLM-Based Agents Aug 2025

- AEJMC 2025, San Francisco, CA
 - Division: Communication Technology
 - Scholar-to-scholar poster presentation
- [5] Wang, Z., Cao, L., Kim, D., Jung, B., Kim, J. Y., Yang, A., & Williams, D. Quantifying local donation networks: The impact of geographical partisan heterogeneity and news use on political donation Jun 2025
- ICA 2025, Denver, CO
 - Work-in-progress paper session
- [4] Kim, D., Choi, E., Curry, M., Cao, L., Zhou, S., Kim, J. Y., Leccese, M., Jung, B., Kim, N., Zeng, W., Brunn, L., Wang, Z., Yang, A., & Williams, D. (2025). Exploring the impact of social influence on group well-being in massively multiplayer online games: Evidence from Sky: Children of the Light Jun 2025
- ICA 2025, Denver, CO
 - Division: Game Studies
 - Poster session
- [3] Kim, J. Y., & Miller, L. Do violent versus nonviolent multiplayer video games impact subsequent prosocial behavior? A meta-analysis May 2025
- 2025 KACA conference, Washington, DC
 - Student research paper session
- [2] Kim, J. Y., Cao, L., Isherwood, K., & Jang, E. (2025). Fact-checking and mitigation behavior intentions of climate change misinformation memes among individuals of different beliefs Apr 2025
- 2025 Annenberg Graduate Fellowship Research and Creative Project Symposium, Los Angeles, CA
 - E-poster session
- [1] Kim, J. Y. (2024). Reveal the users' needs that motivate watching gaming videos with topic modeling Aug 2024
- AEJMC 2024, Philadelphia, PA
 - Division: Mass Communication and Society/Student Competition.
 - Refereed research paper session

AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS

- Annenberg Fellowship Award, University of Southern California 2023 – Present
For fellowship support and Teaching/Research Assistant appointment.
- Annenberg Graduate Fellowship Research and Creative Project Symposium Award, University of Southern California 2025 – 2026
For symposium presentation
- Annenberg Summer Educational Fellowship, University of Southern California 2026
Support for participation in a summer educational workshop.
Attended SCoDA Workshop: Statistics on Complex Data, hosted by Seoul National University, South Korea
- Student Success Fund, University of Southern California 2025
For extra- and co-curricular academic programs support
- Dean's List, Ewha Womans University 2016 – 2020
For having earned over 15 credits for the semester with no failed courses and a minimum 3.75 GPA
- Honor Scholarship, Ewha Womans University 2016 – 2020
Awarded for academic excellence (top 2% by year level)
- Ewha Boston Alumnae Scholarship 2017
For outstanding academic performance and clear future goals

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- Teaching Assistantship** University of Southern California, Los Angeles, California, USA
- Uses of Communication Research Aug 2024 – Dec 2025
Supported Master's students in conducting statistical analyses with SPSS and applying quantitative methods such as surveys and experiments
 - Communication Management Pro-Seminar Jan 2025 – May 2025

Supported Master's students in writing research papers, focusing on structure, clarity, and APA academic style

PEER REVIEW SERVICE	Journal Reviewer	
	International Journal of Communication	2026
	Conference Reviewer	
	- National Communication Association (NCA), [Game Studies Division] - International Communication Association (ICA), [Game Studies Division; Environmental Communication Division] - Korean American Communication Association Conference (KACA), - Association for Education in Journalism and Mass Communication (AEJMC), [Mass Communication and Society Division; Communication Technology Division]	2024 – 2026 2024 – 2026 2025 – 2026 2024 – 2025
PROFESSIONAL SERVICE	KACA–NCA Student Representative	Korean American Communication Association (KACA), National Communication Association, USA
	- Student Representative - Organize the KACA graduate student social event at the National Communication Association (NCA) annual convention in 2025–2026. - Promote graduate student engagement and networking within the Korean American communication research community. - Collaborate with the KACA Executive Board to support student-focused initiatives.	Nov 2025 – Nov 2026
CAMPUS ACTIVITIES	Korean Graduate Student Association	University of Southern California
	- Vice President - Organized networking events, career development workshops, and academic workshops for Korean graduate students. - Managed the association's operations, budgets, and communications. - Worked with other student organizations and universities, including the University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA) and California Institute of Technology, to provide support and resources for Korean graduate students.	Aug 2024 – May 2025
	Ewha Student Ambassador Program	Ewha Womans University, Seoul, South Korea
	- Ambassador - Visited high schools in Korea to promote one's college, utilizing various media materials based on student demands	Mar 2018 – Aug 2018
OTHER WORK EXPERIENCE	SKT 0 Fitial Contest	Seoul, Korea
	- Contest Participant - Planned and executed a public relations campaign targeting adults in their 20s and 30s in South Korea, promoting a positive brand image of SKT - Leveraged advanced social media skills to design the campaign process on Instagram, ensuring targeting audience interests	Mar 2019
	Olympic Broadcasting Services	Gangneung, South Korea
	- Camera Director Assistant - Assisted camera directors at the PyeongChang 2018 Olympic Winter Games, arranging the shooting environment and materials to improve broadcasting productivity.	Feb 2018
LANGUAGES	- Korean: Native. - English: Fluent. - Japanese: Intermediate.	
SKILLS	Python, Natural Language Processing, Machine Learning (Transformer model), R, SPSS	

[CV compiled on 2026-08-26]